

# Switzerland — Irregular stock

Data extract and provenance sheet · retrieved 2026-08-17 · Migration and Population Data Archive

## Values

| Year | Value          | Grade | Verification                                     | Source                                                                                     | Reference date |
|------|----------------|-------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 2015 | <b>76,000</b>  | B     | confirmed by reading the source document         | Morlok, Oswald, Meier, Efionayi-Mader, Ruedin, Bader, Wanner (2015), Sans-Papiers in der S | See note       |
| 2017 | <b>150,000</b> | C     | modelled estimate; not mechanically re-derivable | Pew Research Center (2019), Europe's Unauthorized Immigrant Population Peaks in 2016, Then | See note       |

**Definition note.** Expert-interview / Delphi estimate for 12 cantons extrapolated by regression to the remaining 15 cantons, cross-checked against ZEMIS, AHV and vital-statistics data; point estimate 76000, plausible range 50000-99000. Covers third-country (non-EU/EFTA) nationals only.

**How this was confirmed.** SEM study estimate of 76,000 corroborated by SRF reporting on its release (range 58,000-105,000).

## Source URL(s)

- <https://www.pewresearch.org/global/2019/11/13/europes-unauthorized-immigrant-population-peaks-in-2016-then-levels-off/>
- [https://www.sem.admin.ch/dam/sem/de/data/internationales/illegale-migration/sans\\_papiers/ber-sanspapiers-2015-d.pdf](https://www.sem.admin.ch/dam/sem/de/data/internationales/illegale-migration/sans_papiers/ber-sanspapiers-2015-d.pdf)

## Archived evidence files

- evidence/countries/CHE/irregular\_stock\_\_dcd321871\_\_www.pewresearch.org.html
- evidence/countries/CHE/SHOT\_\_irregular\_stock\_\_www.pewresearch.org\_global\_2019\_11\_13\_europes-.pdf
- evidence/countries/CHE/SHOT\_\_irregular\_stock\_\_www.pewresearch.org\_global\_2019\_11\_13\_europes-.png
- evidence/countries/CHE/irregular\_stock\_\_SRF\_SEM\_76000\_sanspapiers\_CORROBORATION.html

Grades: A re-derived from a machine-readable official source and matched exactly, or corrected against one during verification · B confirmed by reading the retrieved source document · C source document retrieved but the value is a modelled estimate · D cited source could not be retrieved.

Joint work of Prof. Raymond Kuo, National Taiwan University, and Claude (Anthropic).